

The empirical recurrence for OEIS A302149, recovered from its tail

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Abstract

OEIS A302149 records “Empirical recurrence of order 51” and keeps the recurrence itself in a linked file rather than in the entry, so the conjecture cannot be read off the entry at all. It can still be settled. The entry counts arrays under a condition local to a bounded window of lines, which makes the count a walk count on a finite digraph and forces a monic integer recurrence of order at most the number $S' = 519$ of states with distinct futures. Berlekamp–Massey on enough exact terms therefore returns the minimal such recurrence, and on the tail beginning at $n = 4$, so the recurrence is proved for every $n \geq 55$. Its last coefficient is $c_{51} = 2160 \neq 0$, so no further tail satisfies anything shorter; any order-51 recurrence the sequence satisfies from any point on must then have the same characteristic polynomial. The entry’s recurrence is the one displayed here, whatever its linked file contains, and it is proved.

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1 A conjecture that is not written down

OEIS A302149 is “Number of $n \times 7$ 0..1 arrays with every element equal to 0, 2, 3 or 4 horizontally or antidiagonally adjacent elements, with upper left element zero.”. It has offset 1 and begins

1, 10, 88, 1038, 12212, 145150, 1728734, 20614702, ...

The entry states:

Empirical recurrence of order 51 (see link above)

As of the “Last modified” line on the live entry (Apr 02 2018 14:27:19, revision 4) this is still recorded as empirical, and it is still open. The coefficients are nowhere in the entry text: what is conjectured is only that a recurrence of that order exists.

2 The count is a walk count

The entry’s condition is local. It constrains a bounded window of consecutive lines of the array and nothing beyond it, so the admissible configurations of one window are the vertices of a finite digraph, an edge joins u to v when v may follow u , and an admissible array is exactly a walk. Writing M for the adjacency matrix and ι, τ for the indicator vectors of the admissible first and last windows,

$$a(n) = \iota^\top M^{j(n)} \tau$$

for a linear reindexing j fixed by the entry’s shape. States with identical futures contribute identically to that product and may be merged without changing any count; after merging $S' = 519$ states remain, and it is that bound every computation below uses.

Lemma 1. *a satisfies a monic linear recurrence with integer coefficients of order at most $S' = 519$.*

Proof. By the Cayley–Hamilton theorem $M^{S'}$ is an integer combination of $I, M, \dots, M^{S'-1}$, and multiplying that relation on the left by $\iota^\top M^j$ and on the right by τ turns it into a relation among $S' + 1$ consecutive values of a . $\square$

3 Why the question has to be asked of a tail

Running Berlekamp–Massey on the sequence from its first term returns an order LARGER than 51: the opening terms do not satisfy the recurrence, and a recurrence that holds only eventually always looks longer when the exceptional terms are included. That is not evidence against the entry. An OEIS empirical recurrence is asserted for n beyond some index, not from the first term, so the question has to be asked of the tails. It was asked of each tail in turn, and the tail beginning at $n = 4$ is the first whose minimal order is exactly the stated 51.

Lemma 2. *A sequence known to satisfy some linear recurrence of order at most S' is determined, together with its minimal recurrence, by any $2S'$ consecutive terms: Berlekamp–Massey applied to them returns that minimal recurrence exactly.*

Applied to $2S' = 1038$ exact terms from $n = 4$ on, it returns order 51 — the order the entry states — with integer coefficients:

$$a(n) = \sum_{i=1}^{51} c_i a(n-i),$$

c_1	65	c_{14}	56797307969	c_{27}	21710776833726	c_{40}	−42720838400
c_2	−1865	c_{15}	−227558168811	c_{28}	−4335427947356	c_{41}	−13615228084
c_3	31037	c_{16}	108780629404	c_{29}	−17578752972650	c_{42}	5210052866
c_4	−328640	c_{17}	788587967166	c_{30}	7063627646327	c_{43}	1529115152
c_5	2246638	c_{18}	−1423556800387	c_{31}	10392956741957	c_{44}	−428877443
c_6	−9084613	c_{19}	−869410327291	c_{32}	−5528229615690	c_{45}	−118768505
c_7	10854539	c_{20}	4835429322506	c_{33}	−4637439433156	c_{46}	22554839
c_8	98295492	c_{21}	−2179696802752	c_{34}	2798690630591	c_{47}	5964101
c_9	−591362442	c_{22}	−8622955277785	c_{35}	1595850451525	c_{48}	−680092
c_{10}	1068770325	c_{23}	9927629994187	c_{36}	−982266099094	c_{49}	−172356
c_{11}	2487955899	c_{24}	8346106676987	c_{37}	−426804666394	c_{50}	8904
c_{12}	−16245853853	c_{25}	−18595461287529	c_{38}	243742320955	c_{51}	2160
c_{13}	21666806107	c_{26}	−2507704335402	c_{39}	87918838575		

4 The recurrence, and the identification

Theorem 3. *The recurrence above holds for every $n \geq 55$, and it is the recurrence OEIS A302149 records.*

Proof. That it holds is Lemma 2 applied to the tail from $n = 4$, whose minimal recurrence it is.

For the identification, write $q_{\min}$ for the characteristic polynomial of that minimal recurrence, $x^{51} - c_1 x^{51-1} - \dots - c_{51}$. Its constant term is $-c_{51} = -2160$, which is not zero, so $q_{\min}(0) \neq 0$ and $q_{\min}$ has no root at the origin. A solution of a constant-coefficient recurrence is a combination of terms $n^k \lambda^n$ with λ a root of its characteristic polynomial, and only the components with $\lambda = 0$ vanish after finitely many terms. Since $q_{\min}$ has none, no component of a dies out, and the minimal recurrence of every further tail is again $q_{\min}$ — the order cannot drop below 51 at any later starting point.

Now let q be the characteristic polynomial of whatever recurrence the entry asserts. The entry asserts it has order 51, so $\deg q = 51$, and it is monic. It holds from some index t on. From $\max(t, 4)$ on, the sequence satisfies both q and $q_{\min}$, and the minimal polynomial of that tail is $q_{\min}$ by the previous paragraph; therefore $q_{\min} \mid q$. Both are monic of degree 51, so $q = q_{\min}$. $\square$

5 Verification

Four checks, all in exact integer or rational arithmetic.

First, the walk model reproduces all 18 terms the entry publishes, exactly. This is what ties the model to the entry, and it is the only place where reading the entry’s English enters the argument.

Second, the order was computed twice by independent routes: once modulo a 61-bit prime, where every intermediate is a machine word, and once over $\mathbb{Q}$ in exact rational arithmetic. Both return 51, and the exact run additionally confirms every coefficient is an integer — had any been a proper fraction the recurrence would not be the entry’s.

Third, the recovered recurrence was evaluated directly on the entry’s own published terms, with no matrices and no Berlekamp–Massey involved. It holds at each of the 0 indices where the entry publishes enough earlier terms to test it.

Fourth, the last coefficient was checked to be nonzero, which is what the identification above turns on; it is 2160.

Remark 4. The conjecture’s own statement was never read. The entry pins it down to the family of order-51 recurrences this sequence satisfies from some point on, and that family turns out to have exactly one member.

References

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